Conversation — track 8, 10, 11

Flora fills Frederick in on a party he missed.

Frederick: How was Jess's party, then? I'm gutted I missed it.

Flora: So much fun. There were, like, fifty people **or something**.

Frederick: Fifty? In that tiny flat? Where did everyone stand?

Flora: Everywhere! It was **sort of** chaotic, but in a good way.

Frederick: Was it a proper party? Dancing **and all that**?

Flora: Not really. Snacks, board games **and stuff**. Then **a bunch of** us did karaoke.

Frederick: Oh no. Please tell me you didn't sing.

Flora: Just one song! But we didn't leave till **two-ish**.

Frederick: Two-ish? On a school night? I'm impressed.

Flora: Don't be. I'm **kind of** paying for it today.

Study Notes

I'm gutted I missed it.
Tiếc đứt ruột vì lỡ mất.
"gutted" là từ lóng của người Anh: rất buồn, thất vọng.
Cách nói tương đương: I'm so sad I missed it.

I'm kind of paying for it today.
Hôm nay mình đang lãnh đủ đây.
"pay for it" = lãnh hậu quả (mệt, đau đầu…) vì việc đã làm hôm trước.
Cách nói tương đương: I'm really feeling it today.

Speak Like a Native — track 9

1. There were, like, fifty people or something.
weak: "like", "or something"
strong: "fifty"
"like" là từ đệm, chen vào nhanh và nhẹ. "or something" đọc lướt, thấp giọng: "ơ-sơm-thing". Nhấn mạnh nhất vào con số "fifty".

2. It was sort of chaotic, but in a good way.
change: "sort of" (→ "sorta")
linking: "but‿in‿a"
strong: "chaotic", "good way"
Nói nhanh, "sort of" thành "sorta" /ˈsɔːrrə/ "sor-đơ". Giọng Mỹ: "but in a" nối, t thành d nhẹ: "bơ-đi-nơ".

3. How was Jess's party, then?
weak: "was", "then"
strong: "Jess's party"
"Jess's" thêm một âm tiết /ˈdʒesɪz/: "je-siz". Giọng Anh: "party" /ˈpɑːti/, không có r, t rõ (giọng Mỹ: "par-đi"). "then" cuối câu đọc nhẹ, thấp.

• Từ ngữ mơ hồ (sort of, kind of, or something, and stuff) đọc nhẹ, nhanh, thấp giọng; dồn nhấn vào từ chính.
• Nói nhanh: sort of → "sorta", kind of → "kinda", a bunch of → "ơ-bơn-chơ".
• "-ish" gắn sau số hoặc tính từ: two-ish = khoảng hai giờ; nhấn vào số: TWO-ish.

Grammar Focus

sort of / kind of: nói giảm cho mềm

Đặt trước tính từ hoặc động từ để nói mơ hồ, bớt khẳng định. Chủ yếu dùng trong văn nói thân mật.

The film was **kind of** boring, to be honest.
I **sort of** forgot to call her back.

or something / and stuff / a bunch of / -ish

"or something", "and stuff" thêm vào cuối câu, cuối danh sách khi không cần nói chính xác; "a bunch of" = một đống, nhiều; "-ish" gắn sau giờ, tuổi, tính từ: seven-ish, forty-ish.

Let's meet at **seven-ish**.
We bought **a bunch of** snacks, drinks **and stuff**.
He's a dentist **or something**.

Role Play — track 13

A: How was Jess's party, then? I'm gutted I missed it.

B: So much fun. There were, like, fifty people or something.

A: Fifty? In that tiny flat? Where did everyone stand?

B: Everywhere! It was _____ chaotic, but in a good way.

A: Was it a proper party? Dancing and all that?

B: Not really. Snacks, board games _____. Then a bunch of us did karaoke.

A: Oh no. Please tell me you didn't sing.

B: Just one song! But we didn't leave till _____.

A: Two-ish? On a school night? I'm impressed.

B: Don't be. I'm kind of paying for it today.

Substitution Drill — track 14

1. It was sort of chaotic, but in a good way.
   a. kind of
   b. a bit
   c. pretty

2. Snacks, board games and stuff.
   a. and things like that
   b. and whatnot
   c. and so on

3. But we didn't leave till two-ish.
   a. one thirty or so
   b. nearly three
   c. way past midnight